

I know that my Redeemer lives.
What comfort this sweet sentence gives!
He lives, he lives, who once was dead.
He lives, my ever-living Head.

Let's just orient ourselves - where we've been, are, going

5 Books of Moses

Torah = instruction / Gods Covental instructions and the stories of how people did/did not respond to those covental instructions.

History Literature

Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Kings, Chronicles, Esra, Nehemiah, Ester

Wisdom Literature

Job, Psalms, Provers, Ecclesiastes, *Song of Solomon*

Filled with poetry, pithy statements that could be applied generally in your lives.

Prophets

Not chronological, nor clustered by kingdom.

Multiple Prophets from within various timestamps within the History Literature

Was Job a fictional character?

- Q: Was Job a fictional character? An analogy? Or a historical person.
- Liberty Jail - Winter 1838-39
- D&C 121:7-8, 10
 - From v10, to me it seems more likely that Job was historical
 - God is the same God today as he was in the Old Testament
- God himself has a purpose and a plan, and he is in charge.
- Ancient Mesopotamia version of why people suffer:
 - I'm just in trouble because I did something wrong, but I don't know what it is.
 - There wasn't sense that the Gods in the Ancient middle-east had a plan for their health, prosperity, posterity and salvation.
- D&C 122:7 - ...know that, my son,

Verse 1, part 2

He lives to bless me with his love.

He lives to plead for me above.

He lives my hungry soul to feed.

He lives to bless in time of need.

Wise King Solomon

- The superficial rationality of people anciently was that if you had material prosperity, that meant that you were wise and that God was with you.
- The truth is that that is part of how God shows you that he is with you, but not the only thing.
- Think about Solomon, he had all this wealth and he was claimed to be the wisest person.
- This text complicates that and says that: you can be very righteous and wise, and have that all fall apart as it did for Job.
- It kinda provides a fuller prospective than what we get in other parts of the Old Testament about what wisdom and righteousness really lead to.

Job's rich and abundant blessings

Job 1:1 - The point to Job's story is not to know with exactitude where the land of Uz is, nor his genealogy, nor the timeline of when Job was alive. It is to learn of the experiences Job had.

v2,v3

We've set the stage with all these rich and abundant blessings that Job has been granted in his life.

- 7k sheep
- 3k camels
- 500 yoke of oxen
- 500 "she-asses"

Verse 2, part 1

He lives to grant me rich supply.

He lives to guide me with his eye.

He lives to comfort me when faint.

He lives to hear my soul's complaint.

Of course he's going to love you...

v6, v8, v9, v10

- He is so privileged, of course he's going to love you. Of course he's going to serve you. He has no other option.
- The only reason Job obeys you is because you bless him with prosperity.
- Let Job suffer, then we'll see how righteous he is.
 - WHAT? Why does God allow this?
 - Then we assume this book is going to answer that question:
 - Why does God allow good people to suffer?

v12

v14 oxen, v15 she-asses, v16 sheep, v17 camels, v18 sons & daughters and the house.

v20 - fell down upon the ground, and worshipped

- At this point he has a decision to make: fall down in worldly sorrow, or fall down in meekness and humility.
- Instead of choosing to curse God, in this case he chooses to draw closer to God through his suffering.

v21, v22

Verse 2, part 2

He lives to silence all my fears.

He lives to wipe away my tears.

He lives to calm my troubled heart.

He lives all blessings to impart.

Job 2 - Job's still faithful, time for his reward?

- v3 - Notice how he's still choosing to love me.
- v4, v5 - Satan: well, of course, because he still has his health.
- v7 health
- v9, v10 - Are we only going to receive good from the Hand of the Lord?
We turn away - from the most intelligent being in the universe - at the first sign of trouble?

Enter the three friends:

v11 - does that sound like the Waters of Mormon - mourn with those who mourn, and comfort those who stand in need of comfort.

v12, v13

- Fix | Solution | Explain
- How often have we all suffered and really what we need is for someone to just be with us.
- How often have you been in a circumstance where you saw someone suffering and you didn't have the right words, but you knew that just being with them would be enough.

Q: What is the purpose of this life?

- What would Job say:
 - Ugh, I wish I hadn't had to go through any of those trials. I wish life would have been simple.
 - OR: Oh my heavens, let me tell you what I learned about myself and about the Lord through this incredible, difficult, long, grooving, process of major trials and loss.
- You and I - in our own struggles - can be reminded that, when we are called to go through trials, it's not a sign of divine disfavor, but maybe that God is giving us another course in curriculum of moral life.
- To learn, to grow, to progress, to become more like Him.

Verse 3, part 1

He lives, my kind, wise heav'nly Friend.

He lives and loves me to the end.

He lives, and while he lives, I'll sing.

He lives, my Prophet, Priest, and King.

More orientation...

1-2 Prologue

3-27 Dense Hebrew Poetry - Dialog / Debate

29-41 Monologue

42 Epilogue

The Debate...

1-2 Prologue

3-27 Dense Hebrew Poetry - Dialog /

Job, Elipaz, Bildad, Zophar

Job
Job
Job
Job



1. Is God just?
2. Does he run the universe on the strict principle of justice?
3. How is Job's suffering to be explained?

Big Assumption

Human Action -> God's Justice

Wise & Good -> Success & Reward

Evil & Stupid -> Disaster & Punishment

	Argument:	Implication:	Conclusion:
Job	I'm Innocent!	My suffering is not divine justice	1. God doesn't run the world according to Justice 2. God is unjust.
The Friends	God <u>is</u> just	God runs the world according to justice.	Job "must have" sinned. ch22

Emotional Rollercoaster

“He destroys the blameless and the wicked, he mocks the despair of the innocent.” - 9:22-23

“God attacks me, tears me up in anger, and gnashes his teeth at me” - 16:9

“Why has God denied me justice and made my life bitter?” - 27:2

“What hope do the godless have when God takes away their life?” - 27:8

Job 19

v25

- Redeemer -
- Job is essentially saying: I have a set of blessings that God will restore to me. He will put back into my life, or give me my life back, redeeming what was once mine.
- God as the Redeemer has the responsibility and the authority to give back to people and to restore to them things that they once had.
- Again: the purpose of coming down here?
- God never intended for you to be your own redeemer.
- It was to find yourself in situations where you have to rely on the Lord to redeem you.

v26

29-41 Monologue - (Closing Arguments)

Job 29-31 - Asserts his innocents and Demands explanation from God

I sign my defense, let the Almighty answer me! - 31:35

Elihu 32-37 - Same Argument and Implication as the friends, but concludes:

Suffering may be a warning to avoid future sin because it builds character.

BTW: Don't accuse God, Dude!

God 38-41

Job 38-41

- God speaking in such a way that shows that His thoughts and His ways are so much... infinitely higher than our thoughts and our ways and our perspectives.
 - Do you have any about the Creation
 - Do you know the laws of nature.
 - Commanded the sunrise or controlled the weather?
 - Do you know how all of these things work? In the animal/plant kingdoms, in the solar system?
 - Are you going to counsel he who does on what he should do differently?
- Job's Assumption => Deeper Assumption
 - Job has enough perspective to make such a claim.
 - God's response - Job doesn't have a universal vantage point.
 - Job is not in a position to accuse God.
 - Would you like to micromanage the world for a day according to the strict principles of justice that he and his friends assume? Punishing every evil deed of every person at every moment with precise retribution?
 - It's extremely complex, it's never black and white.
- Trust and Reliance on God as your Redeemer.

42 Epilog

- Job: I retract and I repent
 - Acknowledges that he overstepped his bounds.
- God to friends: You three spoke wrongly about me.
 - Their ideas about God's justice were too simple.
 - Not true to the complexity of the world or God's wisdom.
- God to Job: Job has spoken rightly about me.
 - This is surprising, because it can't apply to everything Job said.
 - We know that Job drew hasty and wrong conclusions.
- God Honors
 - Job's struggle
 - God approves of Job's wrestling
 - Job's honesty
 - With all of his emotion and pain and simply wanted to talk to God himself.
 - Job's prayer
 - That's the right way to process through all of this.

Job 42

v5, v6

- You don't have to have committed a serious sin to need to repent.
- In fact, you don't even need to have committed a sin at all to repent.
- Because to repent - here - means that you turn to the Lord and you say - more than you have in the past - here I am, I will be thy servant. I will do whatever thou asketh of me.

The Book of Job invites us to...

- ... trust God's wisdom when we do encounter suffering, rather than try and figure out the reason for it.
 - When we search for reason, we tend to either simplify God - like the friends
 - Or, like Job, accuse God, but based on limited evidence.
- ... honestly bring our pain and our grief to God, and to trust that God actually cares and that he knows what he is doing.

Verse 4, part 2

He lives! All glory to his name!

He lives, my Savior, still the same.

Oh, sweet the joy this sentence gives:

“I know that my Redeemer lives!”